

THE ONE GOD MANIFESTED IN FLESH

Why This Doctrine Is the Very Foundation of Your Salvation

The Question That Determines Eternity

There is a question that sits at the very center of your salvation. It is not a question about church membership. It is not a question about good works or religious rituals. It is the question of who God is and who Jesus is. Get this wrong, and you have missed the entire gospel. Get this right, and the doors of eternal life swing wide open. The apostle Paul wrote to Timothy these powerful words:

And without controversy great is the mystery of godliness: God was manifest in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached unto the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up into glory (1 Timothy 3:16).

This is the mystery that the devil has worked for two thousand years to obscure. The religious systems of men have twisted this simple truth into a complicated puzzle that no ordinary person can understand. But the Bible is not complicated. God is not confused. And salvation is not a riddle. Let us go back to the beginning. Let us go back to the greatest commandment of all.

The Shema – God's Jealousy Clause

Moses spoke these words to Israel: "Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD." (Deuteronomy 6:4). The scribe in the New Testament understood this exactly as it was written. When Jesus quoted the Shema, the scribe responded: "Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he." (Mark 12:32). Do you see it? The scribe said "none other but HE" – a single, singular, mathematical Person. One plus zero equals one. There is no addition. There is no subtraction. There is only one. When Moses spoke these words, every Israelite understood that Yahweh was a singular Person—the Father—who had no partners in the Godhead.

The profound, never-preached angle is this: The Shema is God's jealousy clause. It is the legal foundation for the First Commandment ("no other gods"). If God were a Trinity, He would be a community of three divine Persons who love each other—but a community does not get jealous over itself. A single Person who is absolutely alone in His divinity can and does demand exclusive worship, because there is no other divine Being to compete with. That singular Person is the Father, and He alone is the Source of all things. This turns the Shema

from a dusty creed into the most piercing, personal claim in scripture: "I am alone in this universe as God—therefore, give Me your whole heart, because no one else can save you." Now watch how this "jealousy clause" echoes through the entire Old Testament. God Himself declares:

"I am the LORD, and there is none else, there is no God beside me: I girded thee, though thou hast not known me." (Isaiah 45:5)

"Thus saith the LORD the King of Israel, and his redeemer the LORD of hosts; I am the first, and I am the last; and beside me there is no God." (Isaiah 44:6)

"Ye are my witnesses, saith the LORD, and my servant whom I have chosen: that ye may know and believe me, and understand that I am he: before me there was no God formed, neither shall there be after me. I, even I, am the LORD; and beside me there is no saviour." (Isaiah 43:10-11)

How many times does God have to say "there is none else" before we believe Him? He says it again and again. There is only one God. There is only one Person who is God. That Person is the Father. But here is the deeper revelation that will shake your soul: God's jealousy is not a petty emotion—it is the logical consequence of His singularity. When the First Commandment says, "Thou shalt have no other gods before me" (Exodus 20:3), it is not a demand born of insecurity. It is a declaration born of mathematical fact. There are no other gods to have! To worship anything else is not just disobedience—it is cosmic absurdity, because there is nothing else divine in existence. God says:

"For thou shalt worship no other god: for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God." (Exodus 34:14)

Did you catch that? His name is Jealous. Why? Because He is the only God. A community of three could share the worship—they could say, "Worship all of us, and we will share the glory." But a single, solitary, absolute Person cannot share His glory with anyone, because there is no one to share it with. That is why He thunders:

"I am the LORD: that is my name: and my glory will I not give to another." (Isaiah 42:8)

If God were a Trinity, He would have to say, "My glory will I not give to another person of the Godhead"—but that would make no sense, because they would already share the same glory. No, the truth is far more piercing: God is alone in His deity, and He will not give His glory to any creature, any angel, any man, or any so-called "second person." The only way He

could give His glory to a man is if that man is Himself. And that is exactly what happened in Jesus Christ. The apostle Paul confirms this singular Person:

"But to us there is but one God, the Father; of whom are all things, and we in him; and one Lord Jesus Christ, by whom are all things, and we by him." (1 Corinthians 8:6)

Notice carefully: one God, the Father. Not three persons. Not a Trinity. One God – and that one God is the Father. Jesus is called "Lord," but He is not called "God" in this verse. There is a distinction: the Father is the one true God, and Jesus is the Lord whom that one God sent—but as we shall see, that Lord is the Father's own self made visible.

How the One God Saved Us – The Manifestation

Now here is where the revelation becomes breathtaking. If there is only one God – only one Person who is divine – then how could that one God save us? The answer is found in 1 Timothy 3:16: "God was manifest in the flesh." The same one God – the Father – the invisible Spirit whom no man has seen or can see – manifested Himself in flesh. He wrapped His unapproachable glory in a body of his own Word. He became visible. He became touchable. He became one of us. The very same "HE" of the Shema—the singular, jealous God who would not share His glory—took that glory and hid it in a body, so that He could walk among us without consuming us. Moses asked to see God's glory, and God replied:

"Thou canst not see my face: for there shall no man see me, and live." (Exodus 33:20)

But God is love. He wanted to be seen. He wanted to be known. He wanted to be touched. So the invisible Father did the only thing that could satisfy both His holiness and His love: He made Himself a body. That body was Jesus. The glory that no man could see was veiled in flesh, so that we could look upon it and live. Isaiah prophesied this:

"For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace." (Isaiah 9:6)

The child is called The everlasting Father. How can a child be called the Father? Because the Father is the Spirit, and the child is the flesh – but both are the same Person, the same God, the same "HE" of the Shema. The Father did not send a substitute. He sent Himself, wrapped

in the flesh of a child. Jesus Himself declared this truth plainly: "I and my Father are one." (John 10:30). The Jews understood exactly what He meant. They picked up stones to kill Him – not because He claimed to be like God, but because He claimed to be God:

"The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God." (John 10:33)

They were right about what He claimed. They were wrong about whether it was true. Jesus was not a second person of a Godhead. Jesus was the one God – the Father Himself – walking among them in flesh. When Philip asked to see the Father, Jesus answered: "Have I been so long time with you, and yet hast thou not known me, Philip? he that hath seen me hath seen the Father; and how sayest thou then, Shew us the Father?" (John 14:9). Not a reflection. Not a representative. Not a separate person who looks like the Father. He that has seen Me has seen the Father. Because Jesus is the Father manifested in flesh. Paul wrote to the Colossians:

"For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily." (Colossians 2:9)

All the fullness. Not part of the Godhead. Not one-third of the Godhead. All the fullness of the Godhead – bodily. The entire, undivided, one and only God – dwelling in a body called Jesus.

Why This Doctrine Is for Your Salvation

Now we come to the most important question of all: Why does this matter for your salvation? Let me give you three reasons why the truth that Jesus is the Father manifested in flesh is not just a theological opinion – it is the very foundation of your salvation.

First: Only God Could Save You, and Only This Doctrine Shows He Did

If Jesus were merely a created being – even the highest, most exalted creature in all of heaven – He could not save you. A creature cannot save another creature from the infinite penalty of sin against an infinite God. Only God Himself could pay the price that God Himself demanded. Isaiah declared: "I, even I, am the LORD; and beside me there is no saviour." (Isaiah 43:11). If there is no saviour beside the LORD, then the saviour must be the LORD. Jesus is that Saviour. Therefore, Jesus must be the LORD Himself – the Father manifested in flesh. The apostle Peter preached: "Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved." (Acts 4:12). Why is there no other name? Because there is no other God. The name of Jesus is the name of the one

God who came to save us. When you call on the name of Jesus, you are calling on the Father who dwells in that name. The name "Jesus" means "Yahweh is Salvation." The Father's name is Yahweh. Jesus is the Father's salvation made flesh. Paul wrote to Timothy:

"For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus; who gave himself a ransom for all." (1 Timothy 2:5-6)

Notice: the mediator is the man Christ Jesus. Not a God-man hybrid. Not a second divine person wearing a human costume. A man who was also the one God manifested in that flesh. As a man, He could die, as God he could not because God is a Spirit. As God manifested in that man, His death had infinite value. If Jesus were not God Himself – the Father in flesh – His death would be the death of a mere man, and it could save no one. But because God was manifest in the flesh, that flesh could die, and the infinite God who dwelt in that flesh could satisfy the infinite justice of God against sin. Your salvation depends on this: only God could save you, and God did save you – by effectuating salvation through his own flesh.

Only This Doctrine Gives You a Saviour Who Truly Loved You

The Trinity doctrine teaches that the Father stayed in heaven while the Son came to earth. According to that teaching, when Jesus died on the cross, the Father turned His back on the Son. The Father abandoned the Son. The Father punished the Son. But think about what that means. If the Father punished a separate person – the Son – to satisfy His own justice, then the Father did not pay the price Himself. He made someone else pay. That is not love – that is vengeance by proxy. It is like a judge who sentences his own child to death to satisfy his own legal code, while he himself walks free. That is not justice—that is cruelty. But the truth of Scripture is far more glorious:

"To wit, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto himself, not imputing their trespasses unto them." (2 Corinthians 5:19)

God was in Christ. Not a separate person. Not a substitute. God Himself – the Father – was in that body, reconciling the world to Himself. The Father did not punish someone else. The Father took the punishment Himself. The Father wrapped Himself in flesh, suffered in that flesh, bled in that flesh, and died in that flesh – so that you could live. This is love. This is the gospel. This is the good news that sets men free. It is not a story of a Father who demanded blood and a Son who provided it. It is a story of a Father whose Word was made flesh to save

His own children. The Father did not stand at a distance watching His Son die. The Father was in the Son. When Jesus cried out on the cross, "My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?" (Matthew 27:46), the Father was in that body, reconciling the world to Himself. If you believe in a Trinity, you believe that God sent someone else to die for you. If you believe the truth of Scripture, you believe that God was in Christ, and allowed him to be put to death in the flesh. 1 Peter 3:18 "For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit". Which is more comforting? Which is more loving? Which is more worthy of worship? Your salvation depends on this: you are saved not because someone else died for you, but because God Himself loved you enough to be manifested in the flesh and put his own flesh to death for our sakes.

Only This Doctrine Gives You Eternal Life in Unity with God

Jesus prayed to the Father on the night before He was crucified: "And this is life eternal, that they might know thee the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent." (John 17:3) Eternal life is knowing the only true God – the Father – and Jesus Christ whom the Father sent. But if Jesus is not the Father manifested in flesh, then knowing Jesus is knowing a separate person, not knowing the only true God directly. But because Jesus is the Father in flesh, when you know Jesus, you know the Father. When you see Jesus, you see the Father. When you believe in Jesus, you believe in the Father. There is no separation. There is no middleman. There is no distance between you and God. The apostle John wrote:

"Whosoever denieth the Son, the same hath not the Father: but he that acknowledgeth the Son hath the Father also." (1 John 2:23)

Why? Because the Father and the Son are not two – they are one. To deny the Son is to deny the Father. To acknowledge the Son is to acknowledge the Father – because the Son is the Father manifested. You cannot have one without the other, because they are not two separate beings—they are the same being expressed in Spirit and in flesh. When you are baptized in the name of Jesus (Acts 2:38), you are baptized in the name of the Father – because the name of the Father is Jesus. When you call on the name of Jesus, you call on the name of the Father – because the Father has given His name to His manifested flesh. Your salvation depends on this: you cannot have the Father without the Son, because the Son is the Father in flesh. And you cannot have the Son without the Father, because the Father is the Spirit within that flesh.